

JINGYI TONG

Postdoctoral Research Associate

Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management, Cornell University

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EDUCATION

Iowa State University	2020 - 2025
• Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics • Fields of Interest: Agricultural and Environment Economics, Experiment Economics	
University of Wisconsin-Madison	2018 - 2020
• M.S. in Agricultural and Applied Economic	
University of Colorado-Denver	2015 - 2018
• B.A. in Economics, Minors in Math, International Studies	
China Agricultural University	2014 - 2018
• B.A. in Economics	

WORKING EXPERIENCE

Cornell University, Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management	Current
• Postdoc Research Associate, working on experiment design on willingness to pay and conservation adoption	

RESEARCH FOCUS

Technology adoption, Cropland Use, Agricultural Pollution, Environmental Policy, Conservation Practice Adoption, Farmland Tenure and Ownership, Experiment Design, Women in Agriculture, Extension and Outreach

WORKING PAPER

- **Jingyi Tong**, Otavio Bartalotti, Wendong Zhang. “Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest.” (*Journal of Environmental Economics and Management* Revise & Resubmit)
- **Jingyi Tong**, David Hennessy, Shuchao Ye, Chaoqun Lu. “Grid-Level Dynamic Land Use Analysis of Farm Policy Changes in the U.S. Corn Belt with Application to Nitrous Oxide Emissions.” (*American Journal of Agricultural Economics* under review)
- **Jingyi Tong**, William Chen, Wei Zhang, Wendong Zhang. “County-Level PFAS Contamination Site Density and Associations with Chronic Disease and Cancer in the United States.” (*BMJ Public Health* under review)
- Jasmin Wehner, Tongzhe Li, **Jingyi Tong**, Wendong Zhang. “Asymmetric Consumer Responses to Competing Sustainability Attributes of Innovation.”
- **Jingyi Tong** and David Hennessy. “Rootworm Corn Seed Disadoption: Land Use & Regional Welfare Consequences in the Inner Corn Belt.”
- **Jingyi Tong**, Jacqueline Comito, Wendong Zhang. “Who Influences Whom? Gendered Peer Effects in Edge of Field Practice Adoption among Farmers.”
- Shuchao Ye, **Jingyi Tong**, Chaoqun Lu. “Declining Crop Diversity Increases N₂O Emission in the United States”
- **Jingyi Tong**, Yu Wang, Wendong Zhang “Who Pays for Mobile Microgrid Resilience? Demand, Siting Preferences, and Neighborhood Disadvantage.”

PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATION

- Xiaolan Wan, **Jingyi Tong**, Jacqueline Comito, Wendong Zhang. “Is a Farmer a Better Messenger than an Extension Professional for Conservation Practice Adoption?” *Forthcoming Agricultural Economics*

- **Jingyi Tong**, Michael Bootsma, Wei Zhang, Wendong Zhang. “Factors Influencing the Adoption of Flexible Lease Arrangements in Iowa.” *Journal of the ASFMRA*. 2026: 11–24.
- **Tong, J.**, J. Benning, C. DeLong, M. Schultz, W. Zhang. “What women landowners want to know about conservation.” *Renewable Agriculture and Food Systems*. 2024. 39(e35).
- Schultz, M., J. Benning, C. DeLong, C. Hyde, M. O’Rourke, L. Scarbrough, K. Tidgren, **J. Tong**, W. Zhang. 2022. “Survey Increases Understanding of Iowa Women Farmland Owners.” *Journal of The NACAA*. 15(2) ISSN 2158 9429.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Does Conservation Reserve Program Improve Crop Yield and Resilience?” (Shuaiqi Wu, **Jingyi Tong**, Shuchao Ye)
- “Consumers’ Willingness to Pay for Green Ethylene Plastic Bags: A Discrete Choice Design” (Yu Wang, **Jingyi Tong**, Hermine Zhou, Wendong Zhang)
- “What Drives Organic Cucurbit Growers to Adopt Mesotunnel Row Covers? An Application of the Technology Acceptance Model.” (**Jingyi Tong**, Wendong Zhang, Katie Dentzman)

OTHER PUBLICATION & REPORTS

- Wehner, J., **J. Tong**, W. Zhang, T. Li, K. Pulliam, D. Gonthier, A. Sciligo, E. Miller. 2025. “Kentucky Consumer Perceptions and Key Attributes in the Willingness-to-Pay Study for Cucumbers.” Cornell SC Johnson College of Business Research Paper. <http://dx.doi.org/10.2139/ssrn.5767702>
- **Tong, J.**, and W. Zhang. 2023. “Iowa Farmland Ownership and Tenure Survey 1982 – 2022: A 40 Year Perspective.” Iowa State University Extension and Outreach, FM 1893.
- Hart, C., **J. Tong**, W. Zhang. 2023. “The Continuing Evolution of Iowa Farmland Ownership and Tenure: Results from the 2022 Survey.” *Agricultural Policy Review*. Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, Iowa State University.
- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2022. “Educational Preferences on Farmland Leasing, Conservation Practices, and Transition Plans: Voices of Iowa Women Farmland Owners.” Center for Agricultural and Rural Development, Iowa State University.
- **Tong, J.**, Y. Zhou, and Z. Luan. 2016. “Establishing the Educational Evaluation System of Academic Advising for Sino-foreign College.” *24th International Conference on Computer in Education: Think Global Act Global –Workshop Proceedings*, Mumbai, November 28 - December 2.

BLOG POSTS

- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2023. “Crop Share Leasing Provisions, 2022”. Ag Decision Maker. Iowa State University Extension and Outreach. <https://www.extension.iastate.edu/agdm/wholefarm/html/c2-30.html>
- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2023. “Survey of Iowa Leasing Practices, 2022”. Ag Decision Maker. Iowa State University Extension and Outreach. <https://www.extension.iastate.edu/agdm/wholefarm/html/c2-15.html>
- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2023. “Iowa Farmland Ownership and Tenure Survey 1982 – 2022: a forty-year perspective”. Ag Decision Maker. Iowa State University Extension and Outreach. <https://www.extension.iastate.edu/agdm/articles/zhang/ZhaJun23.html>
- **Tong, J.**, W. Zhang. 2022. “Voices of Iowa Women Landowners on Conservation”. Iowa Learning Farms. <https://iowalearningfarms.wordpress.com/2022/06/15/voices-of-iowa-women-landowners-on-conse>

OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Postdoc, Cornell University (Supervisor: Prof. Wendong Zhang) 2025-Present

- Cost-benefit analysis of applied agrivoltaics in commercial farms in New York, also known as dual-use agriculture and solar photovoltaics (funded by New York State Energy Research and Development Authority).

- Field experiment: Consumer willingness to pay for vegetation grown under row covers (USDA-funded project); and follow-up surveys to explore hypothetical bias, framing effects, and plastic aversion.
- Farmers' willingness to pay for saturated buffer adoption: Reducing hypothetical bias using a real payment in experimental settings (The Nature Conservancy & Iowa Nutrient Research Center (INRC) funded project)
- Gender, delivery format, and wildlife conservation information: Experimental evidence on adoption of edge-of-field conservation practices (INRC-funded project)

Research Assistant, Iowa State University (Supervisor: Prof. David Hennessy) 2024

- Environmental impacts of commodity and fertilizer price changes on crop rotation and cropland expansion: Evidence from satellite data and an integrated economic-ecological model
- Impacts of rootworm Bt corn, alternative meat, and carbon policies on land use and welfare outcomes

Research Assistant, Iowa State University (Supervisor: Prof. Wendong Zhang) 2022-2023

- Land leasing, conservation, and succession among Iowa farmland owners (INRC-funded project)
- Extension and outreach to women landowners on farmland leasing, conservation, and succession (USDA funded project)

Research Assistant, UW-Madison (Supervisor: Prof. Xiaodong Du) 2019,2021

- Effects of dairy insurance programs on dairy farm bankruptcy in Wisconsin
- Predictive and causal analysis of Airbnb listing prices using machine learning
- Literature review and data preparation on ERCOT wind-power markets

Project Member, UW-Madison (Supervisor: Prof. Emilia Tjernström) 2019

- Cost & benefit analysis of the Payments for Ecosystem Services (PES) program in Burkina Faso (World Bank Development Impact Evaluation Unit)

Research Assistant, China Agricultural University (Supervisor: Prof. Zhiqiang Luan) 2016

- Establishing an educational evaluation system of academic advising in Sino-foreign departments

SKILLS

Economic modeling: applications of satellite remote sensing big data; instrumental variables and their use in nonlinear models; difference-in-differences models (and variants); lagged dependent variable models; contingent valuation methods; information treatments and field experiments.

Software skills: various AI tools, R, Stata, ArcGIS Pro, Python, LaTeX, Tableau, SPSS, Microsoft Office.

CONFERENCES, WORKSHOPS, AND PRESENTATIONS

- **2026 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**
Who Influences Whom? Gendered Peer Effects in Edge of Field Practice Adoption among Farmers
- **2026 International Workshop on Survey Design and Experimental Methods in Applied and Agricultural Economics**
- **2026 Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference**
Less Plastic Waste or Fewer Pesticides? Experimental Evidence on Consumer Responses to Competing Sustainability Attributes
- **2026 Chinese Economists Society - North America Annual Conference**
Grid-Level Dynamic Land Use Analysis of Farm Policy Changes in the U.S. Corn Belt with Application to Nitrous Oxide Emissions
- **2025 World Bank Land Conference**
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest
- **2024 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**
Dynamic Land Use Impact of Crop Insurance Subsidies in the U.S. Corn Belt: A Grid-Level Analysis
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest

- **2024 Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association (NAREA) Annual Meeting & Workshop**
Institutional Land Ownership and Conservation Practice Adoption in the U.S. Midwest
- **2024 Food & Human Values Society (AFHVS) and the Association for the Study of Food and Society (ASFS) Conference**
What Drives Organic Cucurbit Growers to Adopt Mesotunnel Row Covers? An Application of the Technology Acceptance Model
- **2024 Extension Risk Management National Conference**
Women Landowners' Voices from Iowa: Empowering Expertise in Farmland Leasing, Conservation, And Transition
- **2023 Iowa Nutrient Research Center**
Landowners Matter Too: Accelerating Adoption of In-field and Edge-of-field Nutrient Reduction Practices through Better Engaged Landowners
- **2023 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**
Land Management and Environmental Responses to Carbon Subsidies in the US Corn Belt
- **2022 Women in Ag Leadership Conference**
Leave Your Legacy: Planning for Farmland Leasing, Conservation, and Succession
- **2022 Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) Annual Meetings**
Safety Net Programs and Family Farms Bankruptcy: Evidence from Wisconsin Dairy Farms

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Economic Department, Iowa State University

- **Stand-alone Instructor:** Principles of Microeconomics
- Teaching Assistant: Rural Property Appraisal, Introduction to Data Analysis in Agri-Food Industry, Introduction to Agricultural Market, Farm Business Management, Microeconomic Theory

REVIEWER FOR PEER WORK

Environmental Research Letters, Journal of Soil and Water Conservation, Future Foods, The Journal of Extension, Environmental Research Communications, Journal of Rural Studies

AWARDS

- “Women Landowners’ Voices from Iowa: Empowering Expertise in Farmland Leasing, Conservation, and Transition.” 2023 AAEA Graduate Student Extension Competition - second place.
- First-class academic scholarship with title *Deans List*; Distinguished student with Honor *Cum Laude* at the University of Colorado-Denver
- University Scholarship for Academic Performance at China Agricultural University

REFEREE

David A. Hennessy
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